

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Noble Glorious Yakṣa-Holder'

Ārya Jambhala Śrī Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 768 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་གནད་འཛིན་དཔལ་ལྷན་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 768 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Jambhala Śrī Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Dhāraṇī Called "The Noble Glorious Yakṣa-Holder." It belongs to the class of dhāraṇī literature and concerns Jambhala, the yakṣa king of wealth, who at the urging of Vajrapāṇi reveals his mantra and life-essence for the benefit of beings afflicted by poverty and suffering. The text is framed as a canonical discourse in which the Buddha is present at the Grove of Palms, lending it the form of a sūtra-style scripture, though its primary purpose is the transmission of a protective and efficacious dhāraṇī. As part of the Kangyur's collection of dhāraṇī texts, it reflects the tradition of invoking powerful non-human figures within a Buddhist framework to alleviate worldly hardship.

In the language of India: Ārya Jambhala Śrī Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called "The Noble Glorious Yakṣa-Holder."

Homage to Jambhala (the yakṣa king of wealth), King of Yakṣas, the Glorious Holder.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One, the Glorious Vajrapāṇi of the Grove of Palms, dwelt at that sacred place, surrounded by a great retinue of yakṣas. At that time the Lord of Secrets declared to Jambhala, the King of Yakṣas, the Glorious Holder: "For the sake of pacifying sentient beings who are poor and afflicted with suffering, teach the life-essence that is your own vital core, together with your mantra of knowledge. I too will bestow my blessing."

Then the Glorious Holder replied:

Lord of Secrets, Blessed One,
for the sake of pacifying the suffering of sentient beings,
I shall teach this mantra of knowledge.

Abandon suffering and attain happiness.

Those who wish to perfect the two great accumulations
should recite this mantra of knowledge and hold it entirely
in order to protect their own body.

Namo Ārya Jambhala, Mahā Jambhala. Tadyathā: ra ra ra ra, ku nu ku nu, khu nu khu nu, gu nu gu nu, sa pa sa pa, ka ra ka ra, mahā bīram, mahā karḍo, marṣa, haraṣa, tuma sarva satvā, nāna ca svāhā.

When this mantra of knowledge is recited, if one chants the mantra seven times over a blue thread, tying a knot with each recitation and then binding it to the upper arm, one will be free from harm and all one's aims will be accomplished.

Bdellium resin, sandalwood, durva grass, and the compound medicine made with katara — with these one should make offerings.

Namo Ārya Jambhala. Namō danatāya, danatīśvarāya, ākarṣaya, akaramita, danatīśarāya, barma karḍunīya, sarva sattva hita jita, mahā danta. Namaḥ priya-śa samaya ākarṣa svāhā.

When this mantra of knowledge has been recited in full seven times, one should then recite the secret heart-dhāraṇī. Having first made offerings to the noble Three Jewels and to the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, if one then recites this, invoking one's own name, wealth and all that is desired will be accomplished and happiness will be bestowed.

"If I recite and take as my commitment-practice this secret mantra, the wish-fulfilling jewel, then whatever aim has been declared will in its entirety be accomplished."

Then the King of Yakṣas, the Glorious Holder, offered to the Glorious Vajrapāṇi his own heart-dhāraṇī, like a wish-fulfilling jewel:

Namo Ārya Jambhala, Mahā Jambhala, Mahā Jambhala. Tadyathā: si mi si mi, su su su mu, ṇca ṇḍa ṣca ṇḍa, ca ra ca ra, sa ra sa ra, ka ra ka ra, ki ri ki ri, ku ru ku ru, mu ru mu ru, cu ru cu ru, sadaya dama, mama ni damaya nanta, dānateśvā hā, Ārya Jambhala svāhā, dhantāya svāhā, manortha paripūrakāya svāhā.

Then, at that time, the retinue of the yakṣa Jambhala, the Glorious Holder, each recited their own heart-dhāraṇī:

Oṃ Jambhala maṇi bhadrāya svāhā. Oṃ Jambhala pūrṇa bhadrāya svāhā. Oṃ Jambhala dhana dāta bhadrāya svāhā. Oṃ Jambhala mahā dhana dāta bhadrāya svāhā. Oṃ Jambhala civam kuṇḍalī svāhā. Oṃ Jambhala kili mālīnī svāhā. Oṃ Jambhala mukhendrāya svāhā. Oṃ Jambhala jalendrā bhadrāya svāhā.

Then the Lord of Secrets declared: "You, Lord of Wealth, grant happiness according to their wishes to all those who hold, carry, inquire about, and read this dhāraṇī."

Then the Glorious Holder replied to the Lord of Secrets, "So shall it be," and, having performed the customary triple circumambulation, remained in his place.

The Dhāraṇī Called "The Noble Glorious Yakṣa-Holder" is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit title Ārya Jambhala Śrī Nāma Dhāraṇī names Jambhala, the yakṣa deity of wealth cognate with the pan-Indian figure of Kubera or Vaiśravaṇa. The Tibetan rendering of the title, gnod 'dzin dpal, literally means "Glorious Holder of Harm," but functions as a proper epithet for Jambhala in this tradition; "the Glorious Holder" is used throughout as the most natural equivalent.

The phrase rang gi srog gi snying po renders a standard technical term meaning the quintessential life-force or vital-essence mantra of the deity himself, here translated as "the life-essence that is your own vital core" to convey both the technical and literal force.

The identification of the setting as dpal phyag na rdo rje lchang lo can gyi gnas dam pa is unusual. Vajrapāṇi is rarely named as the host deity of a teaching venue; here he functions as the "Lord of Secrets" (gsang ba'i bdag po), Vajrapāṇi's standard esoteric epithet, presiding over a yakṣa assembly. The place name means literally "the sacred place of the Glorious Vajrapāṇi of the Palm-Leaf Grove."

The mantra syllables throughout are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan; no attempt has been made to normalize them to reconstructed Sanskrit, as such dhāraṇī syllables often resist standard Sanskrit parsing.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.